

Review Writing Example 3



Pirates of the Caribbean

Pirates of the Caribbean: A Treasure Trove of a Film

Set upon 18th-century seas, *Pirates of the Caribbean* will sweep you away on a tide of humour, fun and thrilling adventure. With an all-star cast, this is this year's box office hit, already selling out fast across the country. But is it wave after wave of laughs and exhilaration for all the family, or a shipwreck of a movie?

The tale of adventure follows rogue Captain Jack Sparrow (Johnny Depp) across the high seas of the Caribbean, a playground for all pirates, including Captain Barbossa (Geoffrey Rush) who steals Sparrow's ship, the *Black Pearl*, and kidnaps the beautiful yet feisty Elizabeth Swann (Kiera Knightley). The race is on for Jack and Elizabeth's childhood friend, Will Turner (Orlando Bloom), to work together to save Elizabeth and return the *Black Pearl* to its rightful owner. However, unbeknown to the hapless yet charming team of pirates, Barbossa and his crew are cursed and doomed to live as the

undead unless their pillaged treasure is returned...

As the comedic and charismatic Sparrow, Depp has really found his niche with this film. His comic timing and entertaining movements create a character that is loveable and hilarious all under one pirate bandana. Depp has said that he has based his character on ancient Rolling Stones rocker, Keith Richards, and he certainly has the swagger and slur to match. The eyeliner-covered and bejewelled Depp is certainly a film fan favourite, making children and adults alike laugh across theatres. Similarly, Knightley is a strong and feisty female lead, beautiful but unafraid and an excellent role model for all girls everywhere. Swann doesn't need saving by the men – she will save herself, and then if she has half the chance, and the audience instantly warm to her because of her complete disregard for the typical female expectations and roles of the era

in which the movie is set.

The same can't be said of Orlando Bloom, who is a shadowed sidekick to Depp. He seems infinitely more serious and extremely English in his character, giving him a stiff and ultimately unlikable persona in the film. This is a shame as his previous appearances in the *Lord of the Rings* series have been real successes for the actor.

The visual effects in the film, which is the first of an expected trilogy, are fantastic and cleverly woven into reality to create a pirate's dream world. Viewers can feel the sway and surge of the waves as we join Sparrow, Turner and Swann in their swashbuckling adventures: you are literally breathless with excitement as epic sea battles and sword fights unfold in front of you.

See this film if you want a thrill, a laugh and a good old-fashioned love story with a modern twist, but don't expect it to be plain sailing!

Rating: ★★★★★

